

**PINE TREE RIMFIRE BENCHREST LEAGUE
RULES AND PROCEDURES**

- I. Officials
 - a. League Director. The League Director is responsible for calling and conducting league meetings, securing volunteers for league duties. The League Director shall ensure that a “Program” is published containing the course of fire, classes, match and meeting dates, fees, rule changes, qualification requirements for various classes, what targets are to be used, etc.
 - b. Financial Officer. A volunteer Financial Officer shall be assigned who will collect match fees and disburse funds for the conducting of the matches, awards, awards ceremonies and the like. Records of all transactions shall be kept and presented to the PTRC Directors following the season, and at any time as required by the Directors.
 - c. Rules Committee Chairman. A Rules Committee Chairman shall be appointed at the beginning of each season. He recruits a committee which is responsible for interpreting league rules and proposing amendments as required. The committee is responsible for ruling on any disputes not resolved by the scorers or referees.
 - d. Chief Range Officer. A volunteer Chief Range Officer shall be assigned for the season. Alternates shall be appointed should the assigned Chief be unavailable at any given match. The Chief Range Officer is responsible for conducting the matches, and giving range commands.
 - e. Assistant Range Officers. A minimum of two Assistant Range Officers shall be assigned at the beginning of each match to assist the Chief Range Officer in inspecting the firing line after any “cease fire” command.
 - f. Referees. For each match, the Chief Range Officer shall appoint three Referees. The Referees shall inspect competitors’ equipment at their discretion for compliance to the league rules. They shall rule on disputes arising from the conduct of the match.
 - g. Scorers. The League Director shall assign volunteer Scorers for the season. They shall score all targets, rule on the value of all shots, rule on crossfires and any other irregularities, and rule on any protests or complaints as to scoring. It is not necessary for one scorer to score all the targets fired in any class. The scoring duties shall be assigned by the scorers.
 - h. Statistician. The League Director shall assign a volunteer Statistician who shall compile, publish, correct and maintain scores as directed.
 - i. Target Coordinator. The Director shall assign a volunteer Target Coordinator who shall be responsible for maintaining target inventory and for preparing and distributing targets to participants at each match.
- II. Participants
 - a. League Participants. Participation in the league and eligibility for awards is limited to members of the PTRC and applicants for membership in the PTRC who have paid the entry fee for the series per c. below.
 - b. Guests. To encourage others to become PTRC members, or league members, non-PTRC members, and non-fee-paying members are invited to participate in individual matches, but in no more than three matches during the season. Guests are not eligible for awards.
 - c. League Entry Fees shall be paid before the end of activities the evening of the first record match in which the participant fires (not necessarily the first scheduled match) unless there are extenuating circumstances accepted by the League Director.
 - d. Participation in multiple firearm classes. Shooters may participate in multiple firearm classes for which they qualify, and must pay appropriate dues as set forth in the Program published by the League Director.
- III. Classes, Course of Fire, and Targets
 - a. Classes fired shall consist of Sporter Rifle, Sporter Rifle Master, Target Rifle and Target Rifle Master. Classes may be added or deleted prior to any season by action taken in the organizing meetings called by the League Director.
 - b. Determining Class participation.

- i. Participation in Target and Sporter classes shall be determined by the type of firearm to be used, and must be declared for the entire season before a shooter participates. See “Firearms.”
 - ii. Switching classification such as from Target Rifle to Sporter Rifle, and vice-versa shall be permitted. If a shooter elects to switch, he must inform the Statistical Officer before changing, and ensure his targets are appropriately marked before firing. At that point, he has the option of having all past targets disqualified, or having all future targets disqualified, and must so inform the Statistical Officer.
 - iii. Reason for a Master Class. To encourage shooters new to benchrest competition, a Master Class was established for experienced and successful shooters, so that new and developing shooters need not shoot against experienced shooters, and have greater opportunity for securing awards.
 - iv. Any shooter may elect to shoot in a Master Class.
 - v. Shooters who must shoot in a Master Class are the top 6 shooters in a previous year’s Master Class in each division (Sporter or Target) and the top 3 shooters from the previous year’s non-master classes in each division. In other words, a shooter who shot Sporter Rifle, and placed third (for example), and wishes to switch to Target Rifle, must fire in the Target Rifle Master class in the following season.
 - vi. Voluntary switching into or out of Master Class. Switching to, or out of, master class after the beginning of the first scheduled match shall not be permitted.
 - vii. Shooter who mistakes his requirement to fire as a Master and fires on an inappropriate target shall have all such targets disqualified, but may continue to fire on appropriate targets in subsequent matches.
 - viii. Shooters participating in both Target Rifle and Sporter Rifle class must participate as Masters in both classes if they are currently classified as Master status in either class.
- c. Declaring class. Participants shall declare which class or classes in which they intend to compete. The declaration shall precede the first match in which the competitor fires. Competitors are responsible for ensuring they are qualified to fire in the declared class. When in doubt, competitors shall consult the Rules Committee Chairman for clarification. The Chairman’s decision may be accepted, in which case the decision is final, or a shooter may appeal the decision to the League Director, whose decision is final.
- d. Course of Fire. There shall be 25 shots for record to be fired on record bulls and unlimited sighter shots fired on sighter bulls, in 30 minutes. All firing is done at 50 yards.
- e. The targets used by the league are:
 - i. PTRC Five-bull Sporter Rifle Target. This is based in the IBS 100 yard score target, but the 10 ring on the IBS target becomes the X ring on the PTRC target; the 9 ring of the IBS target becomes the 10 ring of the PTRC target, etc.
 - ii. IBS 50 Yard Score Target. This is the green-line target with 25 record bulls and additional sighter bulls.
 - iii. PTRC Target Rifle Master Target. This is a target based on the European 50 meter rimfire score target, but is printed locally with green lines and other subtle modifications. There are 25 record bulls and additional sighter bulls.
- f. Sporter Rifle class fires on the PTRC five-bull Sporter Rifle Target. Sporter Rifle Master Class and the Target Rifle Class fire on the IBS 50 Yard Score Target. Target Rifle Master Class fires on the PTRC Target Rifle Master target.

IV. Equipment

a. Firearms

- i. Target Rifles. Target rifles are defined as any rifle having a safe firing mechanism, weighing not more than 20 pounds inclusive of sight, with a stock having a flat or convex forearm and total stock width not more than 3". The use of muzzle brakes and/or venting or porting of barrels that redirects powder gas flow from following the direct line of the rifle bore shall not be allowed. All

rifles designed or designed by their manufacturer as “target rifles” shall be considered target rifles. Rifle model variations with “heavy barrels” shall be considered target rifles. The use of flat attachments to the fore-end, no more than 3” wide shall be permitted. No “cable release” triggers are permitted. Tuners are permitted.

- ii. Sporting Rifles. The intention is to provide a classification for factory-produced hunting rifles. Sporting rifles are defined as any rifle having a safe firing mechanism, weighing less than 10 ½ pounds inclusive of sight, with a stock having a convex forearm and a total width not more than 2 ½ inches. Aftermarket barrels are not permitted except for those having the configuration of the original barrel made for the rifle. Re-bedding, re-stocking in a recognizable “sporter” configuration are permitted. The use of muzzle brakes and/or venting or porting of barrels that redirects powder gas flow from following the direct line of the rifle bore shall not be allowed. The use of tuners not requiring modifications to the barrel is permitted. The use of a flat attachments to the fore-end, no more than 3” wide is permitted. No “cable release” triggers are permitted. A shooter may elect to fire a Sporting Rifle as a Target Rifle.
- iii. Firing a Target Rifle in Sporting Rifle Class shall result in the disqualification of any targets fired with the Target Rifle.
- iv. Other Firearms. Handguns per NYS’s definition may be used in lieu of Sporting Rifles.
- b. Scopes. Telescopic sights of any magnification may be used, but the weight thereof must be included in the weight of the rifle for classes where there is a weight limit.
- c. Ammunition. Only .22 short, long or long-rifle ammunition firing a single projectile is allowed. Tracer rounds are not permitted.
- d. Rests.
 - i. Standard Rests. Rifles shall be fired from pliable sandbags, both front and rear. Adjustable pedestals supporting the front sandbags placed under forearms are permitted. Blocks, boxes or such to raise sandbags to get proper elevation are permitted. Such blocks and rests may not be attached to the bench tops with wood screws or similar hardware. No machine or other rests (guiding means) that can return rifle to battery or which retard recoil are allowed. Rests for target rifles and sporter rifles shall have a bag filled with sand (not shot), and only this bag and the shooter’s hands, shoulders, etc., may be in contact with the rifle during firing. The front bag must be such that the rifle can be removed in the vertical direction without any front rest or sand bag adjustment.
 - ii. One-piece rests. Rests wherein the structure supporting the fore-end is connected to the structure supporting the butt stock (one-piece rests) are not permitted.
 - iii. Bipods. Bipods attached to the rifle fore-end, in conjunction with a sandbag supporting the butt stock (optionally), may be used in lieu of standard rests.
 - iv. Backpacks, improvised rests. Backpacks and improvised rests are permitted insofar as they are not specifically constructed to circumvent the return-to-battery, shot-filled bag, or one-piece rest prohibitions, and are placed directly upon the shooting bench.
- e. Flags. Wind flags of any size may be placed on the range by competitors.
 - i. The top of flags shall be no higher than the line between the highest point of bench top to bottom of target card.
 - ii. Except as provided for in iii) below, personal wind flags will be restricted to within the competitive shooting lane of the competitor placing the flags. A shooting lane is defined as the centerlines between benches to the centerline between the target cards unique to each competitor.
 - iii. Competitors may place personal wind flags off to the side of the range; that is, left of the left-most bench on the range, and/or right of the right-most and right-most bench being used on a given day at the affected tournament.

- iv. If, after the match is started, a flag is causing an obstruction for any shooter, the Chief Range Officer shall call a cease-fire and direct Assistant Range Officers to lay down the flag and pole in question.
 - v. Unlike IBS' current practice, after a relay, during the cease-fire before a subsequent relay, competitors are permitted to remove their personal wind flags from the range, and shooters firing on subsequent relays may at that time set personal wind flags.
 - vi. The use of electronic wind gauges or similar devices is not allowed.
 - vii. Miniature flags placed on the bench tops are permitted.
- V. Match Operation
 - a. Bench Selection. Bench selection is on a first come/first serve basis. Benches 1-8 and the parking area adjacent to those benches are reserved for participants with vehicle handicap tags or license plates. The reservation of handicapped-designated benches shall expire approximately 15 minutes before competitors are called to their benches. The intention is to provide adequate benches for handicap tag holders, but not have benches go unoccupied unnecessarily. Shooters are expected to be considerate.
 - b. Relay Selection. Relay Selection is on a first come/first serve basis. Participants arriving less than fifteen minutes before the start of the first relay shall be assigned to the second relay. Concessions may be made for PTRC Board members needing a first relay assignment on meeting nights
 - c. Target posting and retrieval.
 - i. Each participant is responsible to post and retrieve their own targets.
 - ii. Each participant is responsible to obtain their official target, for that week's match, from the Target Coordinator
 - iii. Each participant is responsible to turn in their target at the Chief Range Officer's station at the conclusion of each relay.
 - d. Range Commands.
 - i. The following will be read by the Chief Range Officer before each relay. Each participant for that relay must be assembled at the Chief Range Officer's station before the instructions can be read: **"EXCEPT BETWEEN THE COMMANDS 'COMMENCE FIRE' AND 'CEASE FIRE', BOLTS AND CARTRIDGES MUST ALWAYS BE OUT OF THE RIFLE OR A BOLT SAFETY FLAG MUST BE INSERTED IN THE ACTION OF THE UNLOADED RIFLE. IF I MUST STOP A MATCH PREMATURELY, YOU WILL FIRST HEAR AN AIR HORN OR LOUD BUZZER, THEN THE COMMAND 'CEASE FIRE'. YOU MUST LEAVE YOUR RIFLE ALONE, AND WAIT FOR FOLLOW-UP COMMANDS. A SHOT AFTER THE 'CEASE FIRE' MAY RESULT IN A DISQUALIFICATION. ONCE I HAVE ASSESSED THE SITUATION I WILL GIVE FURTHER INSTRUCTIONS. IF IT IS A SAFETY INCIDENT, ALL RIFLES ARE TO BE LEFT UNTOUCHED UNTIL I GIVE OTHER INSTRUCTIONS. OTHERWISE I WILL TELL YOU TO 'CLEAR YOUR RIFLE BY FIRING OR BY OPENING THE BOLT'. BEFORE THE TARGET CREW MOVES FORWARD, ALL BOLTS MUST BE OUT OR BOLT SAFETY FLAGS INSERTED, AND YOU MUST STEP BACK FROM THE BENCH. ANY TIME LOST WON'T BE CHARGED AGAINST YOUR ALLOTTED TIME, AND AN EXTRA ONE MINUTE WILL BE ADDED TO THE REMAINING TIME."**
 - ii. After each participant for the relay has been seated at their bench the Chief Range Officer shall announce in exactly these words: **"THIS IS RELAY NUMBER (1 OR 2). IT IS A 25 SHOT MATCH AT 50 YARDS. YOU WILL BE ALLOWED 30 MINUTES TO COMPLETE YOUR FIRING. BEGINNING AT FIVE MINUTES BEFORE THE TIME LIMIT SHALL EXPIRE; THERE WILL BE A COUNTDOWN AS FOLLOWS: 5 MINUTES, 2 MINUTES, 1 MINUTE, 30 SECONDS, 15 SECONDS, 10 SECONDS, 5 SECONDS, CEASE FIRE."**

- iii. The Chief Range Officer will then give the following commands in the following sequence with an approximate five-second interval between each command: "READY ON THE RIGHT, READY ON THE LEFT, READY ON THE FIRING LINE, COMMENCE FIRING."
- iv. Unlike IBS and NBRSA matches, competitors are NOT required to remain seated until after a "CLEAR THE BENCHES" command. When shooting is completed, shooters may REMOVE BOLTS from rifles or insert chamber indicators, then carefully and safely remove their equipment from the bench in such a way as to not disturb shooters who have not finished. Shooters shall refrain from extended conversations near shooters who have not finished shooting. When the match time has expired or when the last shooter has finished his/her string of fire, whichever shall be earlier, the Range Officer will give the following commands: "CEASE FIRE, CEASE FIRE, CEASE FIRE! REMOVE YOUR BOLTS OR INSERT YOUR BOLT SAFETY FLAGS AND REMAIN SEATED. SHOW YOUR BOLTS OVER YOUR HEAD OR SHOW AN ASSISTANT RANGE OFFICER YOUR FLAGGED ACTION". This applies to anytime that a "cease fire" is called and the benches have to be cleared to allow participants or others down range.
- v. At this point the Chief Range Officer will visually inspect the firing line, with help from the Assistant Range Officers. With a "thumbs up" sign the Assistant Range Officers will signal the Chief Range Officer when all bolts are out and all bolt flags are inserted. Once the Chief Range Officer confirms that the line is safe, he/she shall command: "CLEAR THE BENCHES. YOU HAVE FIVE MINUTES TO REMOVE AND SECURE YOUR FIREARM."
- vi. The Chief Range Officer shall THEN direct target posting and retrieval by match participants. Participants are not to enter the range until the Chief Range Officer has cleared the firing line and has given the participants the command to go down range.

VI. Safety –

- a. PTRC standard safety rules remain in effect during matches and practice sessions.
- b. Remember, no firearm may be handled while participants or officials are down range. At such times the red lights are to be on.
- c. The placing of rifles on rests between matches is allowed provided that the "bolts out" (except non-bolt-action rifles and any rifle where removal of the bolt is not practical – this situation requires the use of an open action indicator/flag) rule is observed and only after the Range Officer has called a competitor's relay to the line, and no personnel are down range.
- d. Open Actions: All actions shall be open and bolts removed (non-bolt-action rifles and any rifle where removal of the bolt is not practical require the use of an open action indicator/flag) except on the firing line between the appropriate commands given by the Chief Range Officer
- e. Firing:
 - i. No shot shall be fired until the command "COMMENCE FIRE" has been given in its entirety or after the command "CEASE FIRE" has been initiated."
 - ii. A competitor firing before "COMMENSE FIRE" in its entirety or after "CEASE FIRE" has been initiated shall constitute grounds for disqualification.
- f. Position of Muzzle: The muzzle of every rifle when in firing position shall be in front of the front edge of the bench upon which it rests.
- g. Emergency Commands: All competitors must obey at once the command "CEASE FIRE" and shall not fire again until the command "RESUME FIRE" is given. In the event that conditions require a suspension of fire, the time of suspension shall not be charged to the time allotted for completion of the relay, an extra one minute will be added to the remaining time.
- h. Sportsmanship: There shall be no boisterous conduct on the firing line during the firing of any event. A rifle range is no place for pranks, and any shooter failing to observe this will be disciplined by the Chief Range Officer.

- i. People Down Range: At no time after firing has commenced will any person, other than range personnel or referees under the direction of the Chief Range Officer, be permitted down range until that range relay has been completed. Any person violating this safety rule may be disqualified by the Chief Range Officer. Down Range means forward of the forward edge of the benches. Leaning forward of the bench to place or retrieve equipment is permitted if done in such a manner as to not disturb other competitors or become a safety issue.

VII.

Scoring

a. General

- i. Scoring shall be done by the trained scoring committee in the range shack
- ii. Scorers shall work in teams of 2 so that the values and arithmetic are checked.
- iii. Scoring shall be done on the day of the match.
- iv. Only scoring committee members are permitted in the range shack during scoring.
- v. No one shall score his/her own target.
- vi. Posting of scored targets shall be at the discretion of the League Director.

b. Determining shot value

- i. Shots shall be scored by the highest value scoring ring touched or cut by the bullet. (“best-edge” scoring)
- ii. A plug-type scoring aid as used in NRA smallbore competition shall be used.
- iii. Magnifying lenses should be used if there is doubt as to the value of a shot.
- iv. Holes may be only “plugged” once. The plug is to remain in the hole until the value is determined.
- v. Where there are multiple bullets making a single hole, making the value of outer shots difficult to measure, the scorer will exercise judgment as to the value of the outside shots.

c. Dealing with cross-fires

- i. The range is not equipped with backing targets to determine crossfires. We rely on an honor system to deal with crossfires.
- ii. Intentional crossfires on another competitor’s target shall be scored as misses on the firer’s target. The Chief Range Officer, at his discretion, may disqualify the offending shooter.
- iii. Accidental, admitted crossfires on another competitor’s target. The participants shall contact the range officer as soon as practical. Any lengthy discussion as to the source of a crossfire shall be postponed to a time after the relay has been completed. If the shooter and receiver of the crossfire agree on which shot is the crossfire, the value is to be transferred to the shooter’s target and one penalty point assessed. Accidental crossfires on sighter bulls shall be likewise brought to the attention of the Chief Range Officer, but no point penalties shall be assessed.
- iv. Accidental, crossfires appearing mysteriously - contact the nearby shooters immediately, and the range officer as soon as practical and endeavor to assess the source. If the source cannot be determined, the scoring committee MAY choose to ignore the crossfire. Otherwise, it will be scored as an excessive hit.
- v. Crossfires on the wrong bull – shall be assigned by the scoring committee’s judgment to the intended bull and assessed one penalty point each.

d. Dealing with excess hits

- i. Competitors shall receive the value of the lowest shot or 25 shots on the target, unless the scoring committee determines that particular shots resulted from crossfires. (Agreement of the shooters involved and the Chief Range Officer shall be required by the scoring committee if lowest shot or lowest 25 are not used for the score)
- ii. If a competitor crossfires, he should NOT fire a replacement shot on his own target. He should get the value of the crossfired shot, less the penalty point. Said value shall be assigned to the corresponding bull in the competitor’s target. If he should fire the replacement shot, he a) may be disqualified for attempting to

- cover up a crossfire (at the discretion of the Chief Range Officer) or b) the crossfired shot less penalty shall be considered an excess hit.
- iii. If a competitor receives a cross fire, he SHOULD fire the required number of shots in the appropriate bull(s) on his own target.
 - iv. If a competitor crossfires on a different type of target than appropriate for his class, the crossfire shall be scored as a miss.
- e. Standard process for scoring “target-class” and “master-class” targets (one shot per bull)
- i. Write the value of the shot within the box (X, 10, 9 ...)
 - ii. Don’t write “10 X” as it creates confusion (Is it a “10” or an “X”?)
 - iii. Add the values of the 5 shots in each row of bulls. For example, if the shots in one row are scored as: 9, 10, X, X, 10, write “49” in the margin to the right of that row of bulls.
 - iv. Add the 5 scores in the right margin. Record the total in the “score” space
 - v. Count the number of bulls containing an “X” and write the total in the score space as X’s. Scores thus written should appear like: 246 – 9X, or whatever the score would be.
- f. Standard process for scoring targets requiring 5 shots per bull
- i. Write the values of the 5 shots in the box in a column, to facilitate addition. For example, write:

X (don’t write “10 X,” just “X”)
 7
 7
 7
 6
 - ii. Then add the column. In the above example, draw a line under the “6” and write “37 – 1X” It is to be understood that an “X” has a score value of 10.
 - iii. Add the totals for the 5 bulls and post the total in the space provided in the same format as done with the “target-class” targets.
- g. Posting scores and targets
- i. Following the day’s shooting, the scoring committee shall compile the scores for all competitors in a form provided. The scores and targets shall be available for viewing after the scoring committee has completed their work.
 - ii. At the discretion of the League Director, the targets may be posted for inspection by the competitors. Competitors may remove their targets only upon completion of score tabulation, and after being released by the League Director. Once removed from the range area, the target’s scores shall be considered final.
 - iii. After the match, the scoring committee may discard any targets NOT removed by the competitor, or by an individual acting on his behalf.
 - iv. At the beginning of the season, the statistical officer shall provide to the Scoring Committee a form for recording and reporting scores for individual matches.
 - v. The Statistical Officer shall be given the compilation of scores after a reasonable period for protests (an hour or so) has passed. He shall compute the rankings to-date for the season and post same via e-mail within the following week, as a general rule.
- h. Breaking ties
- i. Ties for individual match shall be broken as follows
 - X count
 - Value of score in first bull regardless of order actually fired (X beats a 10; 10 beats a 9, etc.)
 - Value of second bull score, etc.
 The Statistical Officer shall break ties for the first three places.
 - ii. Ties for league standings at the end of the season
 - X count
 - Of the 10 best targets a shooter fires, the one fired on the earliest date,
 - Then the ones fired on the second earliest date, etc.

The Statistical Officer shall break ties for the first five places.

i. Protests

- i. Targets will be made available in the clubhouse after they are scored on the day of the match.
- ii. Scores (values and arithmetic) must be protested before targets are removed from the club property by the competitor, and no later than the beginning of the next week's match.
- iii. The Statistical Officer shall have final say on the outcome of the protest (League Director shall have final say should the statistical officer's target be involved)
- iv. Scores become final 8 days from the date on which they are posted unless protested. Protested scores become final upon resolution of the protest.
- v. Exceptions for shooters who must leave before targets are available for inspection due to personal reasons will be determined on a case by case basis – when a serious and obvious error has been made, like mistakes in transcription, addition or scoring off by an entire ring, corrections shall be made. Challenges of scorers' judgment requiring plugging holes, etc., shall not be granted the exception.

3/26/13